

Employee Handbook

Syed Motors · Document Code: POL-01 · Type: handbook · Department: All Employees

Purpose

This company-wide handbook provides the common workplace expectations that apply to employees across Syed Motors. It covers attendance, workplace appearance, communication, leave, confidentiality, and the everyday conduct required to maintain an organised and professional working environment.

The handbook is intended to give employees a practical reference for normal workplace situations. It should be read together with the applicable HR policies, department procedures, safety instructions, and other controlled company documents where a subject requires more detailed rules.

The handbook is effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. It is reviewed annually by the document owner and revised when necessary. The controlled version is Version 1.0.

1. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard workshop hours are 09:00–18:00, Monday to Saturday, with a 30-minute lunch break. Front-office departments follow 09:30–18:30. Employees are expected to organise their arrival, departure, and workday activities around the schedule applicable to their department.

Attendance is not limited to being physically present at the workplace. Employees are expected to record their attendance correctly and to remain available during their scheduled working period. Where work requires movement between workplace areas, the employee should still follow the applicable attendance and reporting arrangements.

Biometric punch-in and punch-out is mandatory for all employees. The attendance record should reflect the employee's own arrival and departure. Buddy-punching, meaning one person recording attendance on behalf of another, is a terminable offence.

Late arrivals beyond three occurrences in a month are treated as a written warning. Employees should therefore treat repeated lateness as a workplace matter and review their routine if attendance records show repeated delays.

If an attendance record appears incorrect, the employee should raise the matter through the appropriate HR channel rather than attempting to alter or bypass the attendance system. The purpose of an attendance record is to provide a reliable company record of working time.

Employee Handbook — Workplace Standards

The following guidance expands the handbook's existing workplace rules without changing the stated working-hour, attendance, or disciplinary requirements.

1. Working Hours and Attendance

Daily attendance practice

Employees should arrive prepared to begin their assigned duties at the start of the applicable schedule. Preparation includes having the required work materials, access credentials, protective equipment where applicable, and other job resources ready. The exact preparation needed may differ between workshop and front-office work.

The 30-minute lunch break applies to the standard workshop schedule stated in this handbook. Front-office employees follow their stated department schedule. Employees should use breaks in a way that does not create avoidable disruption to colleagues or customers.

Attendance records

Employees should make their own biometric punch-in and punch-out entries. Attendance records should not be shared, delegated, or informally substituted with another employee's record. A reliable attendance record also helps HR and department management understand recurring attendance issues.

When an employee notices a discrepancy in an attendance record, the preferred approach is to report the issue through the recognised company process and provide the relevant date or circumstances. Employees should not attempt to create an unofficial replacement record.

Repeated lateness

The handbook specifies that late arrivals beyond three occurrences in a month are treated as a written warning. Employees should therefore monitor their attendance pattern rather than treating each late arrival as an isolated event. A written warning is part of the company's disciplinary framework and does not remove the employee's responsibility to follow the normal schedule.

2. Dress Code

Showroom and customer-facing staff must wear the issued company uniform with clean shoes and a visible name-badge. The uniform and name-badge help customers identify authorised staff and support a consistent professional appearance.

Workshop staff must wear coveralls, safety shoes, and gloves at all times inside the bays. Loose jewellery, open-toed shoes, and non-approved head-wear are prohibited in the workshop.

Practical application

The dress requirements should be followed before entering the relevant work area rather than being treated as something to correct after work has started. Customer-facing employees should check that the issued uniform, shoes, and name-badge are present and suitable for the workday.

Workshop employees should check their required protective clothing before entering the bays. The stated prohibition on loose jewellery and open-toed shoes is especially relevant to maintaining a controlled work environment around workshop activities.

Employee Handbook — Communication and Leave

3. Communication

Internal communication uses the company email and the Syed Motors chat tool only. Employees should use these recognised channels for normal internal business communication so that workplace information remains within the company's approved communication environment.

WhatsApp is not authorised for customer data. Customer information must therefore remain within the company-approved communication and information-handling processes. Employees should avoid forwarding, copying, or discussing customer information through personal messaging channels.

Employees must respond to internal messages within one business day and to customer messages within four business hours. These response periods establish the expected communication rhythm; they do not mean that every message requires an immediate substantive resolution.

Internal communication practice

A useful internal message should contain enough context for the recipient to understand what is required. Where an action is requested, the employee should make the request clear and include the relevant business details available to them. Communication should remain professional and limited to information appropriate for the intended recipients.

Employees should use company email or the Syed Motors chat tool rather than moving an internal discussion to a personal channel. If a message contains customer information, employees should pay particular attention to the confidentiality requirements in Section 5 of this handbook.

Customer communication

Customer messages should be handled within the four-business-hour response expectation. The employee should provide a useful response where the information is available or use the appropriate internal channel when another team member needs to provide the answer.

Employees should not use personal messaging accounts to exchange customer data. If a customer attempts to move a discussion to a personal channel, the employee should continue using the authorised company process.

4. Leave Policy Summary

Confirmed employees are entitled to 14 casual leaves, 8 sick leaves, and 14 annual leaves per calendar year. Planned leave applications must be submitted through the HR portal at least three working days in advance.

A leave request should identify the applicable leave type and the dates requested. Employees should use the HR portal as the formal submission channel rather than relying only on an informal verbal or chat notification.

Sick leave requires a medical certificate if it exceeds two consecutive days. Employees should retain and submit the required supporting documentation through the applicable HR process when this condition applies.

Leave planning

Employees should plan foreseeable leave early enough to meet the three-working-day submission requirement. This gives the organisation a formal record of the request and allows the relevant workplace arrangements to be considered.

Employee Handbook — Leave and Confidentiality

4. Leave Policy Summary

Using the HR portal

The HR portal is the formal channel stated in this handbook for leave applications. Employees should ensure that the request is submitted through the portal and that the selected leave type and requested dates are accurate before submission.

Employees should distinguish between planned leave and sick leave when submitting a request. Planned leave is subject to the requirement of at least three working days' advance submission, while sick leave has a specific medical-certificate requirement when it exceeds two consecutive days.

The handbook states annual leave entitlements on a calendar-year basis. Employees should consult the HR department or the applicable detailed HR policy when they need clarification about matters not covered in this summary.

5. Confidentiality

Every employee handles some volume of customer personally identifiable information (PII). Examples listed in this handbook include CNIC information, phone numbers, vehicle chassis information, and addresses.

Customer PII may never be discussed outside the workplace, shared over personal channels, or copied to personal devices. This requirement applies regardless of the employee's department because different employees may encounter customer information during sales, service, administration, finance, or other business activities.

Handling customer information

Employees should treat customer information as business information that is available only for legitimate work purposes. When viewing customer details, employees should avoid unnecessary disclosure to people who are not part of the relevant work activity.

Customer information should remain within the company's approved working environment. Personal phones, personal computers, private storage locations, and personal messaging channels must not be used to copy or share customer PII.

The confidentiality rule also applies to conversations. Employees must not discuss customer CNIC details, phone numbers, addresses, or vehicle chassis information outside the workplace.

Common confidentiality situations

If an employee needs information for a legitimate work task, the information should be handled through the company's normal systems and processes. If an employee is unsure whether a particular disclosure is permitted, the matter should be raised with the appropriate company owner or responsible department rather than assuming that personal communication is acceptable.

Employees should also take care not to copy customer information merely for convenience. A temporary personal copy can still create an unauthorised record and therefore falls within the handbook's prohibition on copying customer PII to personal devices.

Employee Handbook — Employee Responsibilities and Ownership

5. Confidentiality

Employee responsibility

Confidentiality is an everyday responsibility, not only a requirement for employees who work directly in customer service. Any employee who encounters customer PII should follow the same restrictions stated in this handbook.

When information is no longer needed for a legitimate work activity, employees should not retain additional personal copies. Questions about the correct company process should be directed through the appropriate official channel.

A confidentiality concern should not be resolved by sending the customer information to another personal account for safekeeping. The handbook specifically prohibits sharing customer PII over personal channels and copying it to personal devices.

Employee Responsibilities

All employees are responsible for understanding the rules in this handbook that apply to their daily work. This includes following the applicable working schedule, using biometric attendance correctly, observing the stated dress requirements, using approved communication channels, submitting leave through the HR portal, and protecting customer PII.

Managers and supervisors should reinforce these expectations through normal workplace communication and should direct employees to the relevant controlled policy when a subject requires more detail than this handbook provides.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the HR department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. The handbook therefore serves as a company-wide baseline for everyday workplace expectations, while the applicable detailed policies remain the source for matters that require additional procedural detail.

Quick employee reference

Attendance: Follow the schedule applicable to your department and use your own biometric attendance. Buddy-punching is prohibited and is a terminable offence.

Dress: Customer-facing staff use the issued uniform, clean shoes, and visible name-badge. Workshop staff use coveralls, safety shoes, and gloves; prohibited workshop items include loose jewellery and open-toed shoes.

Communication: Use company email and the Syed Motors chat tool for internal communication. WhatsApp is not authorised for customer data. Observe the stated response periods.

Leave: Confirmed employees have the handbook's stated annual leave entitlements and must submit planned leave through the HR portal at least three working days in advance. A medical certificate is required when sick leave exceeds two consecutive days.

Confidentiality: Protect customer PII, including CNIC, phone, vehicle chassis, and address information. Do not discuss it outside the workplace, share it through personal channels, or copy it to personal devices.

Document control: This handbook is reviewed annually by its owner and revised as necessary. Employees should use the current controlled version and direct clarification questions to HR.